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Trump now says he'll take on prices

Drops some tariffs amid affordability questions

By Alan Rappeport
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Lower prices for coffee and fruit. A 50-year mortgage to reduce monthly home payments. Direct checks of \$2,000 to many Americans. And a new willingness to welcome skilled foreign labor into the United States.

The Trump administration has begun floating a series of ideas over the past several weeks as it confronts the cold reality that its economic policies are not helping many Americans who continue to struggle with elevated prices and a sense of economic pessimism.

Last week's elections made clear that affordability was top of mind for many Americans. Voters in New York propelled Zohran Mamdani, the democratic socialist with an ambitious agenda to lower the cost of living, to victory in the mayoral race. Democratic wins in New Jersey and Virginia were built on promises to address the high cost of living in those states.

Only 30 percent of voters believe President Trump has lived up to their expectations for tackling inflation and the cost of living, according to a recent NBC News poll. That was his lowest mark for any issue respondents

AFFORDABILITY, Page A7

At UMass, a sting, a fire, and unrest

Amherst campus weathers a season far from normal

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST — It has been a rocky few weeks at the University of Massachusetts Amherst.

First came news of a cocaine sting in the Hotel UMass, the esteemed hospitality training hotel located in the Campus Center smack dab in the middle of campus.

Then a massive fire ripped through Olympia Place, a privately owned apartment complex across the street from the university, displacing 230 students.

And on Thursday, hundreds of members of the Professional Staff Union flooded Chancellor Javier Reyes's office to "cordially invite" him to a no-confidence vote in his leadership scheduled for early next month.

All this amid changing federal policies and funding cuts that have forced the state's premier public research university and flagship campus to batten down against stiff financial headwinds.

Some of the choppiness on campus is to be expected: Union tensions are reaching a boiling point after more than 500 days of bargaining,

UMASS AMHERST, Page A10

'I'm stronger than what he did to me.'

ALEYAH FERNANDEZ, speaking about the person who shot her



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Aleyah Fernandez lifted a weight bar with the encouragement of her boyfriend, Donté Harrison, and occupational therapist Rosalie Shnorhokian at Spaulding Rehabilitation Hospital in Charlestown.

A stray bullet paralyzed her but she won't let it stop her

Woman hurt in October shooting finds strength and hope with partner

By Truman Dickerson
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Aleyah Fernandez was walking toward a dispensary in Roxbury with her boyfriend on the afternoon of Oct. 8 when a gunman opened fire, spraying 20 shots in her direction.

The gunman was not aiming at her but at a rival gang member, who ducked unharmed into a nearby restaurant while bullets slammed into the Dudley Street storefront, police said.

Fernandez, 23, was struck once in the spine, leaving her paralyzed her from the waist down, shattering a life she had worked hard to build.

"I was just talking to myself, like, this can't be the way I go out. Things were just going good for me. I got a good job. I had finally got my own place," she recalled thinking as she lay bleeding on the sidewalk. "I was just praying to God, please don't let me die."

Homeless for more than a year after a fight with her mother, Fernandez bounced among shelters and temporary living spaces until securing an apartment in August and a job handling packages at FedEx.

Through it all, her 25-year-old boyfriend, Donté Harrison, stayed by her side. While she was homeless, he regularly reached out to friends to help find her places to stay. At the

time, he was living with his grandmother and his three siblings in a cramped apartment.

As he watched her bleed on the sidewalk, Harrison became panicked. Somebody, Fernandez and Harrison still don't know who, came forward and put pressure on Fernandez's wound and told Harrison to call 911.

"If it wasn't for him holding my wound ... I probably would have been dead," Fernandez said. "Everybody around me was just watching and recording and not saying anything."

Fernandez briefly fell unconscious and when she woke up heard a frantic Harrison.

"I didn't want him to freak out and be

SHOOTING, Page A10

Schools seek solutions to AI-based cheating

Teachers turn to pen and paper, purchase their own detection software

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

Concerned that students will use artificial intelligence to cheat instead of developing critical thinking skills, English teacher David Walsh often has Lexington high-schoolers write the first draft of their essays in class by hand in their notebooks before turning in a final, typed version.

"With the rise of AI, myself and many of my

colleagues are going back to a more analog style of teaching," said Walsh, who has been in the classroom since the mid-1990s.

Lexington teachers have had to develop their own strategies to deal with students' increasing use of AI. The current student handbook doesn't mention AI, after some brief guidance from last year was removed, and Lexington has yet to adopt a districtwide policy. It's a common situation statewide.

A year after an AI-plagiarism lawsuit in Hingham High School made national headlines, few schools in Massachusetts have set clear boundaries on how the technology should be used in

AI, Page A5

9 school districts have adopted AI policies, of the 300 districts in the state.

30 school districts are part of a pilot program to help add AI into curriculums.

Drugmaker Purdue Pharma, long tied to opioid overdose deaths, will soon cease to exist, after a bankruptcy judge said that he'd approve a plan to settle thousands of lawsuits against the company. **A2.**

Russia unleashed a major missile and drone barrage on Kyiv, killing six people. **A4.**

A former director for a company that manages Boston Public Schools' fleet of school buses was arrested and charged with accepting hundreds of thousands of dollars in bribes and kickbacks. **B1.**

Making an art form of political protest

Trump, Epstein statue reappears as controversy that inspired it gets new life

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — On a Sunday in mid-October, sightseers at the National Mall jockeyed for prime picture-taking positions. The subject for most, though, wasn't the US Capitol gleaming in the evening sun or another of the nearby majestic, official landmarks.

Instead, they were photographing a statue hundreds of yards from the Capitol, one that isn't an official monument, but is certainly indicative of a political moment.

The sculpture depicts President Trump skipping hand-in-hand with convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, his former friend. It was inscribed with the esoteric birthday message the

president allegedly wrote to Epstein in 2003.

The statue was removed, but this week, amid newly released emails further linking Trump and Epstein, it re-emerged, this time in front of the popular D.C. restaurant Busboys and Poets.

It's the latest in a series of satirical anti-Trump statues that have popped up in D.C. in his second term. Other examples include a giant gold hand with a thumbs-up crushing the crown of the Statue of Liberty with an inscription that read, "Dictator Approved," and a gilded television fixed atop a pedestal with a plaque quoting a White House statement that read, "In the United States of America you

EPSTEIN AND TRUMP, Page A6



PABLO MARTINEZ MONSIVAIS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Protest art representing President Trump and Jeffrey Epstein was seen outside Busboys and Poets restaurant Thursday in Washington, D.C.



Dimmer switch

Saturday: Sun then clouds. High: 44-49. Low: 38-43.

Sunday: Cloudy and windy. High: 51-56. Low: 33-38.

Sunrise: 6:35 Sunset: 4:22

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